SMB Connect User Guide

v0.7.5 (build 28) · 1 September 2026

Overview

SMB Connect connects to SMB shares by IP address while preferring the fastest configured network path.

Typical uses:

- connect to the same storage over `10GbE` when available and `1GbE` when not
- keep several shares ready in one utility
- preload share definitions from JSON or MDM
- let each user store their own password locally in Keychain

One App, Two Presentations

Use the original **SMB Connect** app as the main interface. It owns saved credentials, selects the preferred or fallback network, performs mounts, runs automatic reconnection, and accepts approved mount requests from apps such as CopyTrust.

The same app has two presentations:

- **Menu bar, the default** — a compact popup for status, Connect, Disconnect, Refresh, Settings, Help, and updates. This is the normal interface.
- **Optional Dock icon and full window** — the same SMB Connect app gains a Dock icon, macOS application menus, and a resizable shares window. The menu-bar control remains available.

To enable the full window, open **Settings** → **General** and turn on **Show Dock icon and desktop window**. Use this mode on a laptop with limited menu-bar space, or whenever you want a persistent window with a share list, expanded status and repair details, and toolbar actions. The window also provides `⌘R` for Refresh, `⌘K` for Connect All, and `⇧⌘K` for Disconnect All.

Changing presentation does not create another configuration or another credential owner. The same SMB Connect process, preferences, Keychain entries, mount logic, and automatic behavior continue underneath. Turning the option off returns the app to its menu-bar presentation.

The separate **SMB Connect Desktop** compatibility app is no longer needed for a full-size interface or for a new deployment. Existing users can read Appendix: SMB Connect Desktop Compatibility App for how that older companion connects through SMB Connect.

How To Use The App

1. Open The App

Click the SMB Connect drive icon in the macOS menu bar.

The popover shows:

- a top banner with your current network information, which turns orange to warn you when the Mac is on Wi-Fi with no wired connection
- a `Connection Summary` section
- a `Shares` section with one status card per configured share
- `Refresh` and `Connect All` as the main actions at the bottom
- a row beneath them with `Settings`, `Help`, `Check for Updates`, and `Quit`
- the app version in that same row for a quick peek (also shown, with build number, in the bottom-left of the Settings window)

`Connect All` is highlighted as the primary action. Hover any of the smaller buttons for a description of what it does.

The top banner and the bottom action rows (including `Quit`) stay pinned in place. Only the `Connection Summary` and `Shares` sections scroll, so the title and buttons remain visible no matter how many shares you have configured.

If you prefer a regular Mac window, open `Settings…`, select `General`, and turn on `Show Dock icon and desktop window`. The full window shows the same shares and live state with more room for network paths, explanations, and repair guidance. You can keep using the menu-bar popup while the window mode is enabled.

2. Read The Connection Summary

The `Connection Summary` section gives a quick count of:

- `Mounted`
- `Preferred`
- `Fallback`
- `Attention`

`Attention` counts only shares you can actually do something about — a duplicate or wrong-path mount, a `/Volumes` name conflict, a volume another user is holding, or a share still needing credentials. A share that is simply offline because its server is switched off or you are away from that network is **not** counted, and shows a grey icon rather than a red one.

Below that is a one-line summary per share so you can quickly scan which shares are connected and on what network speed. A green check means connected. The network-speed badge uses neutral high-contrast text; its small green dot means the preferred path and its orange dot means a fallback path. `Fallback` is also spelled out in orange so the meaning does not depend on colour alone.

3. Read A Share Card

Each share card is centered on one configured share alias.

A card shows:

- the share alias
- the SMB share name
- a status icon and a source badge, at the top right
- a `Connection` pill
- a `Status` pill
- a `Network` pill
- a summary line
- a detail line
- an action button such as `Connect`, `Disconnect`, `Fix Connection…`, or `Complete Setup…`

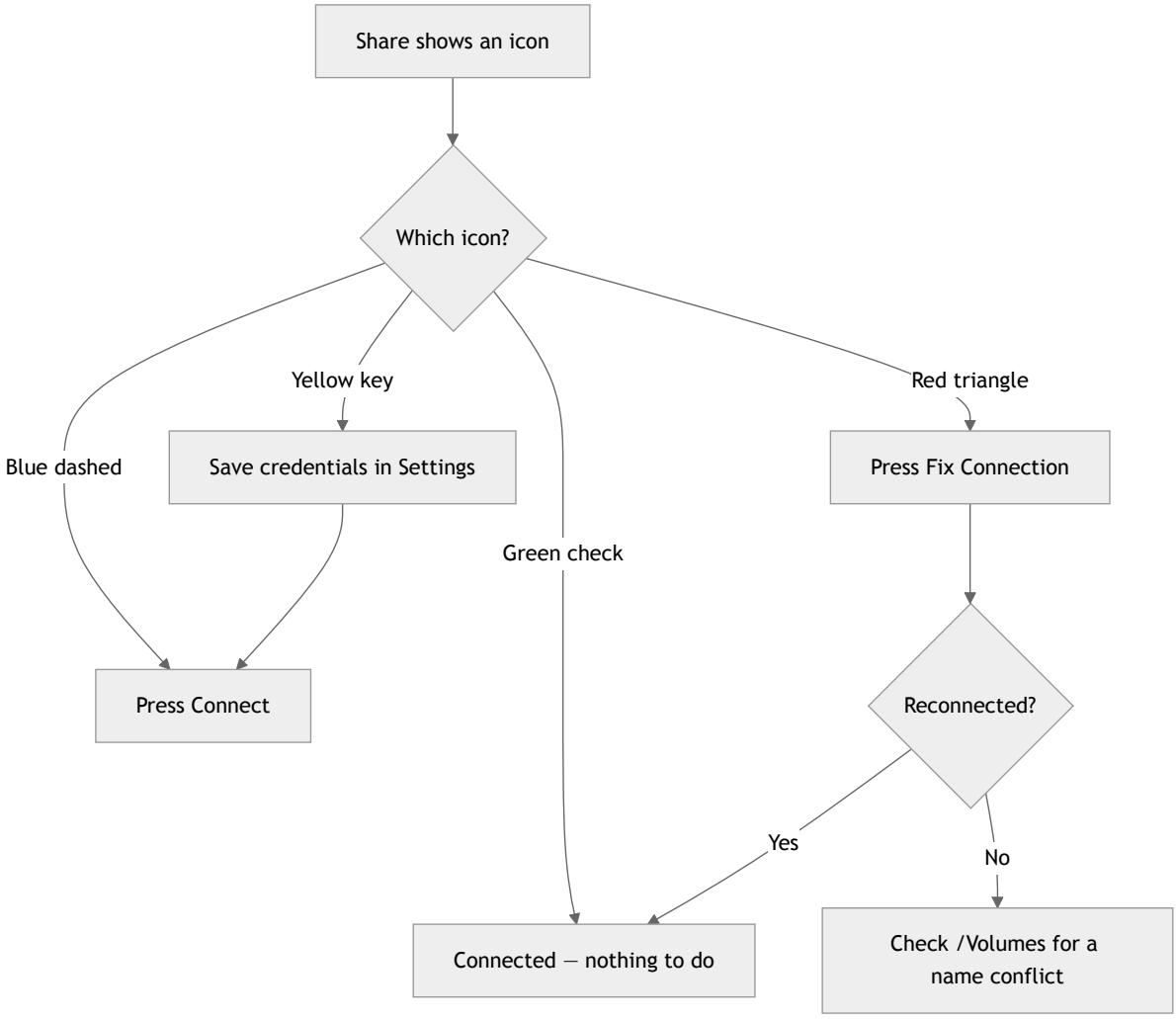
Long share names are shortened with a trailing `…`. Hover the name to see it in full.

Status Icon Legend

The icon at the top right of each card is an at-a-glance version of the same state the `Connection` and `Status` pills spell out below it. Hover any icon to see its wording.

- ✅ **Green check — Connected:** the share is mounted. Nothing to do.
- ✅ **Green check + orange `Fallback` — Connected on fallback:** the share is mounted on a fallback path rather than the preferred one. Nothing to do unless you expected the faster path.
- ◌ **Blue dashed circle — Ready:** a network path is reachable and credentials are saved. Press `Connect`.
- 🚫 **Grey crossed-out Wi-Fi — Offline:** no configured endpoint responded on port 445. Grey, not red: nothing is broken; the server simply is not answering. Check the server is on and that you are on the right network.
- 🔑 **Yellow key — Setup needed:** no credentials are saved for this share. Press `Complete Setup…`.
- ⚠️ **Red warning triangle — Mounted wrong or duplicate:** press `Fix Connection…`.
- 🛑 **Red octagon — Blocked:** a `/Volumes` name conflict is preventing the mount. See *What To Do For A Volume Name Conflict*.
- 👤 **Red person badge — Blocked:** another user logged in on this Mac has the volume mounted. See *What To Do When Another User Has The Volume*.
- ❌ **Red cross — Error:** read the detail line beneath the card.

Or follow it through:



Source Badge

Beside the status icon, a badge shows where the share's configuration came from:

- `User` — added by you in Settings
- `JSON` — imported from a setup file
- `MDM` — supplied by a managed configuration profile and locked

4. Understand The Main Pills

Connection

This tells you the broad connection state:

- `Connected`
- `Ready`
- `Blocked`
- `Not Connected`
- `Error`

Status

This tells you whether the share is on the expected path:

- `Preferred`
- `Fallback`
- `Fix Needed`
- `Duplicate`
- `Setup`
- `Blocked`
- `In Use`

There may also be a second share-state pill such as:

- `Mounted`
- `Available`
- `Reconnect`
- `Setup Needed`
- `Rename /Volumes Item`
- `Other User`

Network

This shows the current or selected network speed for that share, for example:

- `1GbE`
- `10GbE`
- `25GbE`
- `100GbE`

5. Use Connect All

The `Connect All` button (`⌘K`) in the footer connects every share that is currently in a ready state — meaning the preferred or fallback network path is reachable and credentials are saved in Keychain.

It is disabled when no shares are connectable (for example, when all shares are already mounted or no network paths are active).

Shares with missing credentials, name conflicts, or duplicate mounts are skipped and must be resolved individually.

What The Main States Mean

Connected On Preferred Network

The share is mounted and the app believes it is using the fastest configured preferred path.

Connected On Fallback Network

The share is mounted, but the preferred path is not active or not selected.

The check mark stays **green** — the share is connected and there is nothing wrong with it. The word **Fallback** is what appears in orange. In the compact Connection Summary, the speed stays neutral and an orange dot marks the fallback path; on the detailed share card, the full `Network` pill remains orange. A green check always means connected.

Once the preferred path comes back — the wired network returns, or the server starts answering on it again — the share's button changes to `Switch to Preferred…`. It disconnects the share and mounts it once on the preferred path.

Quit Final Cut Pro and anything else with files open on that share first. macOS cannot move a mount without taking it away, and an application holding a file across the switch will lose it. The app asks for confirmation before it does anything.

The button only says `Switch to Preferred` when the preferred path is the one it will actually use. If your fastest path is still down and only a middle fallback is reachable, it reads `Fix Connection…` instead — the mount is still worth repairing, but it is not going where the other label would imply.

Preferred Network Available

The share is not mounted yet, but the preferred network path appears reachable and ready.

Fallback Network Available

The share is not mounted yet, but only a slower fallback path appears available right now.

Complete Setup

The share definition is present, but the user has not yet saved credentials in Keychain.

Duplicate Mount Detected

The app has detected multiple mounted instances such as:

- `Video`
- `Video-1`

This is a warning condition and should usually be repaired before continuing work.

Mount detection only looks at genuine network shares mounted under `/Volumes`. macOS system and automounted volumes — such as the `auto_home` map that appears as a non-local volume literally named `home` at `/System/Volumes/Data/home` — are ignored, so a share whose name matches a system volume (for example a share called `Home`) no longer shows a false `Mounted Wrong` or duplicate state.

Notifications

When a share *newly* enters an attention state — a genuine duplicate, a wrong-path mount, or a `/Volumes` name conflict — SMB Connect posts a single, quiet macOS notification so you are told without having to open the popover. macOS asks for notification permission the first time the app runs; you can change it later in System Settings → Notifications → SMB Connect.

Volume Name Conflict

The app found a local file or folder in `/Volumes` that already uses the share's mount name.

Example:

- local folder: `/Volumes/Video`
- intended share mount: `Video`

If the app mounted anyway, macOS could create `Video-1`, which is exactly what SMB Connect is trying to prevent.

Same Share Mounted Two Ways

A server can be reached by more than one address — its IP, or a Bonjour name such as `nas._smb._tcp.local` that the Finder's **Network** sidebar uses. macOS has no way to tell those are the same machine, so mounting the share through both gives you two volumes, the second suffixed:

```
/Volumes/Storage      from 192.0.2.50              (IP address)
/Volumes/Storage-1    from nas._smb._tcp.local     (Bonjour discovery)
```

This normally happens when a share is mounted once from SMB Connect and once by double-clicking the server in the Finder sidebar. The card names both addresses and which kind each is. Use `Fix Connection…` to disconnect every copy and reconnect once on the configured path, and mount from SMB Connect rather than the Finder sidebar to stop it coming back.

A single mount from an address that is not one of the share's configured endpoints is called out too, before it has a chance to duplicate.

Mounted By Another User

A volume is mounted at a `/Volumes` path once for the whole Mac, not once per user. If a second person is logged in through fast user switching and has already mounted the share, that path is taken and macOS would place your copy at `Video-1`.

macOS gives their mount to their account alone — it is `drwx------` under their user ID — so from your session the folder exists but cannot be opened. Earlier versions of SMB Connect could not see who owned a mount and reported this as a local folder to rename, which was impossible advice.

The share card now names the person holding it and whether they are still logged in. For example:

> Jane Doe (jdoe) has this share mounted at `/Volumes/Video` and is logged in via fast user switching. macOS cannot give you that path while they hold it, so connecting now would mount Shared Video as `Video-1`.

Why `-1` Mount Paths Matter

If macOS mounts a share as `Video-1`, applications may record file paths using that full mounted path.

That is especially risky in Final Cut Pro because relinking later can become more difficult if media paths were recorded using a suffixed mount name.

SMB Connect tries to prevent this by:

- warning when duplicate mounts already exist
- blocking connects when a `/Volumes` name conflict would cause a `-1` mount
- offering repair guidance and reconnect workflows

What To Do For A Volume Name Conflict

If the menu shows `Volume Name Conflict`:

1. Click `Open /Volumes in Finder`.
2. Inspect the conflicting item.
3. Rename or remove the local item that is occupying the intended mount name.
4. Return to SMB Connect and press `Refresh`.
5. Connect again.

If files are already open from that share, quit those apps first.

What To Do When Another User Has The Volume

If the menu shows `Mounted by Another User`, the fix belongs to whoever holds the mount — SMB Connect cannot eject another account's volume, and neither can you without admin rights.

If they are still logged in:

1. Read the card to see who has it and whether they are at the display or switched away.
2. Ask them to eject the volume in the Finder, or switch to their session and eject it.
3. Alternatively, log that user out completely.
4. Return to SMB Connect and press `Refresh`.
5. Connect again.

If the card says they are no longer logged in, the mount was left behind at logout. Press `Copy Unmount Command` and give the copied line to an admin to run in Terminal:

```
sudo umount '/Volumes/Video'
```

Then press `Refresh` and connect again.

`Copy Diagnostics` copies the mount point, the owning account and user ID, their session state, the server and share behind the mount, and the SMB account they mounted with — useful when passing the problem to whoever administers the Mac.

To confirm any of this yourself, `mount` in Terminal lists every mount with the account that made it:

```
mount | grep smbfs
```

Each SMB line ends with `mounted by <user>`, which is the same information SMB Connect now reads directly.

Wi-Fi Warning

The banner at the top turns orange and reads **Wi-Fi only — no wired network** when your Mac has Wi-Fi but no Ethernet connection.

This is a warning, not an error. Shares mount perfectly well over Wi-Fi — that is exactly why it is worth flagging. Nothing fails, nothing reports an error, and the only symptom is that everything you do on that storage is far slower than it should be. Your shares are configured for a wired `1GbE` or `10GbE` path, and for editing work that path is the one you want.

If you see it, plug in Ethernet and press `Refresh`.

Thunderbolt bridges and VPN tunnels are shown but not judged either way — the app cannot tell a 10GbE Thunderbolt adapter from a tunnel, so it reports the connection and leaves the verdict to you.

What `Refresh` Does

`Refresh` does four things:

- re-evaluates any MDM managed preferences pushed since the last refresh
- rescans the setup folder for new JSON setup files
- rechecks active local network interfaces and reachability
- refreshes mounted volume and conflict status

Use it after:

- dropping a new setup JSON into the setup folder
- an MDM policy change is pushed to the device
- changing networks
- renaming or removing an item in `/Volumes`
- disconnecting or reconnecting shares outside the app

In-App Help

You do not need this guide open to get going. SMB Connect has help built in.

Press the `?` button in the menu bar popup, or open **Settings** → **Help** → **Getting Started**. The Help window has two tabs:

- **Quick Start** — adding a share, saving credentials, connecting, and a visual legend for the status icons, plus how to make mounting fully automatic.
- **Advanced** — preferred and fallback network paths, shares over VPN, duplicate mounts and `-1` paths, volume name conflicts, deploying to many Macs, update checking, and what `Refresh` does.

Both tabs link back to this full guide.

Checking For Updates

SMB Connect can tell you when a newer version has been published.

On demand — press `Check for Updates…` in the footer of the menu bar popup. This always checks and always reports back, including when nothing newer exists. If your copy is newer than the published release, it says so and names both versions rather than claiming a match.

Automatically — the app also checks quietly when it launches, at most once every 24 hours. This check is silent unless a newer version is found, in which case an alert offers a `Download` button that opens the release page in your browser.

Nothing is downloaded or installed for you. The check reads only the published version number and compares it against the running app, and no information about your Mac or your share configuration is sent.

Pre-release builds are not offered. You will only be told about full releases.

Settings Window

Open `Settings…` from the menu bar popover.

The Settings window has a left sidebar and a right detail pane.

Sidebar

The sidebar contains:

- `General`
- `Shares`

The `Shares` list shows each configured share alias, source, and preferred network summary.

General Section

This contains:

- `Launch at login`
- `Connect all shares on start`
- `Auto-reconnect dropped shares`
- `Show Dock icon and desktop window`
- `Setup Folder`
- `Refresh Status`

`Launch at login` registers the app with macOS to open automatically when the user logs in.

`Connect all shares on start` automatically connects every share that is in a ready state after the app finishes its first status check on launch. This works the same as pressing `Connect All` manually — only shares with saved credentials and a reachable network path are attempted. Shares with issues are skipped.

`Auto-reconnect dropped shares` monitors connected shares and automatically reconnects any that drop while the server is still reachable. When a share transitions from mounted to unmounted and SMB Connect can still reach the server on TCP port 445, the app disconnects any stale mount points and reconnects cleanly via the best available network path. A 60-second cooldown per share prevents rapid-fire reconnect attempts if the server is flapping. This is enabled by default.

Pairing `Launch at login` with `Connect all shares on start` and `Auto-reconnect dropped shares` gives a fully automatic mount experience: the app opens at login, connects all ready shares without any user interaction, and keeps them connected if a transient network drop occurs.

`Show Dock icon and desktop window` gives the original SMB Connect app a Dock icon, application menus, a toolbar, and a resizable shares window. It does not install or launch another app, and it does not move credentials or mount work to another process. The menu-bar control remains available. Turning the option off closes the full-window presentation and returns SMB Connect to menu-bar-only use.

`Setup Folder` is where the app looks for setup JSON files on startup and refresh:

`~/Library/Application Support/SMBConnect/Setup`

Import / Export

This section is for:

- `Import JSON…`
- `Export JSON…`
- `Open Setup Folder`
- `Export Logs and Diagnostics…`

Use `Import JSON…` to load a setup file manually from anywhere.

Use `Export JSON…` to save the current user-editable share definitions as JSON.

Passwords are not exported.

If you need to create a valid setup JSON file and a matching MDM `.mobileconfig` from a server list, the repo includes a helper script:

- generate_smbconnect_config.sh

It accepts a comma-separated `.csv` or `.txt` file using `alias, protocol, shareName, mountName, defaultUsername, note, preferredIP, preferredSpeed, fallbackIP, fallbackSpeed, allowExternalMountRequests`. The last field is optional for older input and safely defaults to `false`.

and generates both output formats for SMB Connect.

Examples and usage details are here:

- Config Generator README

Reporting A Problem

SMB Connect records what it does to the macOS unified log: every connection state change, every network path it selects, and every mount and unmount along with what asked for it — you, a repair, a switch to the preferred path, or automatic reconnection. It also records the mounts and unmounts **macOS** performs on its own, which is what tells you whether shares dropped because the app disconnected them or because the network did.

`Export Logs and Diagnostics…`, available from the macOS **Help** menu and Settings, writes that log together with your configured shares and their current states, the live network interfaces and the current mount table, into a single text file and reveals it in the Finder. Send that file with your report.

Passwords and account names are not included.

Export it while the problem is fresh. The report covers the last two hours, and macOS discards older entries on its own schedule.

If you would rather read the log directly:

```
log show \
  --predicate 'subsystem == "com.matx.SMBConnect"' \
  --last 1h \
  --style compact
```

The original app appears in the log as `SMBConnect`. If the older compatibility app is also running, its lines appear as `SMBConnectDesktop` under the same logging subsystem.

Share Settings

This section defines the core share identity.

Fields:

- `Source` Admin or config origin, such as user-defined, imported JSON, or MDM-managed.
- `Preferred Network` The first-choice network path for this share.
- `Alias` The display name shown in the menu bar.
- `Protocol` Currently `smb`.
- `Share Name` The SMB share path, such as `Outputs` in `smb://server/Outputs`.
- `Mount Name` The volume name expected in `/Volumes` after the share is mounted.
- `Default Username` A suggested username for the user.
- `Notes` Optional comments about the share.

Network Paths

This section defines one or more IP-based paths to the same share.

Typical use:

- one preferred `10GbE` path
- one fallback `1GbE` path

For each network path, the app shows:

- `Server IP`
- `Network Speed`
- `Priority`
- `Subnet`
- `Label`

Lower priority numbers are preferred first.

Reachability over VPN. SMB Connect prefers an endpoint whose `Server IP` is on the same subnet as one of your Mac's local interfaces (your fast local path). If none of those respond, it then tries every other configured endpoint and connects to whichever actually answers on SMB (TCP port 445). This means a share reachable only through a VPN — WireGuard, Tailscale, a corporate tunnel, or a routed/inter-VLAN path — connects normally even though your `utun` address is on a different subnet than the NAS. When a connection is made over such a routed path, the status detail tags it `(via VPN)`, for example `Current network: 1GbE · 198.51.100.50 (via VPN)`, so an over-the-tunnel connection is always visible.

Credentials

This section stores the user's login details in Keychain.

Fields:

- `Username`
- `Password`

Actions:

- `Save Credentials`
- `Delete Credentials`

Important:

- passwords are saved locally in Keychain
- passwords are not stored in JSON
- passwords are not stored in the MDM profile

The original SMB Connect app is the credential owner. Use its Settings window to create, change, or delete credentials whether you use the compact menu-bar presentation or its optional full window.

External Mount Requests

`Allow apps to request this volume` permits CopyTrust or another local app to ask SMB Connect to mount this share by its configured **Mount Name**. It is off by default. It remains unavailable when two shares have the same Mount Name because SMB Connect will not guess which one the caller meant.

CopyTrust uses the same request model as the SMB Connect Desktop compatibility app: it sends the required Mount Name to SMB Connect, then waits for the volume and its own required folder to appear. CopyTrust does not receive the SMB password, server address, or preferred/fallback network configuration.

IT can force the same per-share setting through the `com.matx.SMBConnect` MDM payload by placing `allowExternalMountRequests = true` in an approved `ManagedShares` dictionary. Managed shares are locked in the UI. For a fleet rollout, generate and validate the exact profile as described in CopyTrust and SMB Connect MDM deployment plan.

An allowed request contains no connection details or credentials:

```
smbconnect://v1/mount?volume=Example_NAS1&request=<uuid>
```

SMB Connect selects the fastest reachable preferred or fallback endpoint and reads the password from its own Keychain item. The caller watches for `/Volumes/Example_NAS1`, then checks the relative folder it needs. For example, CopyTrust may require `/Volumes/Example_NAS1/Archives`; only `Example_NAS1` is sent to SMB Connect, while checking `Archives` remains CopyTrust's responsibility.

Current Status

This section shows the live status for the selected share and any repair guidance.

If the share needs repair or attention, this section explains why.

Ways To Create Configuration

There are several ways to produce share definitions, depending on what you start from. They all end in one of two artifacts: a **setup JSON** (imported per user in the app) or an **MDM `.mobileconfig` profile** (pushed by IT).

- **In the app** — add and edit shares in `Settings…`, then `Export` to a JSON file for backup or to seed another Mac. See `Import / Export` above.
- **Mount Import Assistant** — a small companion app that reads the SMB shares already mounted on a Mac and writes a setup JSON, so you can bootstrap a config from a machine that is already working. The same workflow is available on the command line via `mount_to_smbconnect_config.sh`. See scripts/README-mount-import.md.
- **Generator script** — turn a `.csv` / `.txt` server list into both a setup JSON and a matching profile in one step. See scripts/README-config-generator.md.
- **JSON → profile converter** — when you already have a setup JSON and just need the deployable MDM profile. See scripts/README-json-to-mobileconfig.md.

JSON Configuration

SMB Connect can import and export JSON share definitions.

JSON is useful for:

- bootstrapping users
- copying a setup to another Mac
- keeping a backup of share definitions

JSON can define:

- alias
- protocol
- share name
- mount name
- default username
- one or more network paths
- path priority
- notes
- whether approved local apps may request the volume by Mount Name

Passwords are intentionally omitted.

See:

- Configuration Format
- SMBConnectSetup-EXAMPLE.json
- SMBConnectSetup-DEMO-SIX-SERVERS.json

MDM Profile Configuration

SMB Connect also supports an MDM profile that preloads managed share definitions.

This is useful when IT wants to push:

- share aliases
- share names
- mount names
- preferred and fallback IPs
- network speed labels
- default usernames
- per-share CopyTrust/external-request approval

The user can still enter and store their own password locally in Keychain.

You can build the profile directly from a setup JSON with `json_to_mobileconfig.sh`:

```
./scripts/json_to_mobileconfig.sh \
  -i ./Config/SMBConnectSetup-EXAMPLE.json \
  -o ./Config/generated/SMBConnectSetup-EXAMPLE.mobileconfig
\
  --organization "Example Organization"
```

Two options shape how the profile behaves on the user's Mac:

- `--allow-user-defined true|false` — with `true` (the default) a deployed profile **keeps** each user's own imported shares and merges the managed ones on top, so pushing a profile does not wipe a user's existing setup. With `false`, the app shows only the managed shares.
- `--blank-username` — leave each managed share's `defaultUsername` empty so every user enters their own. Without it, the username from the JSON is baked into the profile and is identical (and locked) for all users on the device.

Passwords are never written to the profile.

For CopyTrust, validate the finished profile before MDM upload. This command requires both fictional example volumes to exist exactly once and to have the external-request policy explicitly enabled:

```
./scripts/validate_copytrust_mdm_profile.sh \
  ./Config/generated/Example-Ingest.mobileconfig \
  Archive Projects
```

Entering Credentials For A Managed Share

A managed share is preloaded read-only, but its username and password are not part of the profile. To finish setup, open `Settings…`, select the managed share, and enter the username and password in the `Credentials` section — they are saved to the user's Keychain and reused on every connect.

> **Requires app v0.5.2 or later.** Earlier builds regenerated a managed share's internal identity on every refresh (about every 20 seconds), which reset the Settings selection and blanked the credential fields as you typed, and prevented saved credentials from being reloaded. v0.5.2 gives managed shares a stable identity so credentials can be entered once and persist. If you deployed an earlier build, install v0.5.2 and re-enter the credentials once; the profile itself does not need to be redeployed.

See:

- com.matx.SMBConnect.mobileconfig
- scripts/README-json-to-mobileconfig.md

Recommended Admin Workflow

1. Create share definitions using one of the methods in Ways To Create Configuration — type them in the app, import existing mounts with the Mount Import Assistant, or generate them from a server list.
2. Preload alias, share name, mount name, and preferred/fallback IPs.
3. Optionally preload a default username, or use `--blank-username` so each user supplies their own.
4. For every CopyTrust destination, explicitly enable `allowExternalMountRequests`; leave it false for other shares.
5. To deploy by MDM, convert the JSON with `json_to_mobileconfig.sh` (or generate the profile directly). Keep `--allow-user-defined true` unless you want to lock users to only the managed shares.
6. Validate every required CopyTrust Mount Name with `validate_copytrust_mdm_profile.sh` before uploading the profile.
7. Let the user open the app and save their password locally in Keychain.
8. Have the user connect from the menu bar app.

Recommended User Workflow

1. Open SMB Connect from the menu bar.
2. Open `Settings…` if a share shows `Complete Setup`.
3. Save your username and password in the `Credentials` section.
4. Return to the menu bar app.
5. Press `Connect All` to mount all ready shares in one action, or connect individual shares as needed.
6. If warned about duplicate mounts or `/Volumes` conflicts, resolve those before editing media.

To connect automatically on every login, enable both `Launch at login` and `Connect all shares on start` in Settings → General.

Troubleshooting

The Share Does Not Connect

Check:

- the configured IP address
- whether the preferred or fallback network is actually active
- whether credentials were saved in Keychain
- whether the target SMB server is reachable

The App Says `Volume Name Conflict`

There is already a local item in `/Volumes` using the mount name. Open `/Volumes`, inspect the item, then rename or remove it before connecting.

The App Says `Same Share Mounted Two Ways`

The share is mounted from two different addresses for the same server — typically its IP and its Bonjour `.local` name. Use `Fix Connection…`, then mount from SMB Connect rather than the Finder's Network sidebar.

To see it yourself, `mount` in Terminal shows the address each mount came from:

```
mount | grep smbfs
```

The App Says `Mounted by Another User`

Another account logged in on this Mac holds the `/Volumes` path this share needs. Ask them to eject it or log them out, then press `Refresh`. If they have already logged out, an admin can clear the leftover mount with `sudo umount` — the card's `Copy Unmount Command` button gives you the exact line.

The App Says `Duplicate Mount Detected`

The share appears mounted more than once. Use the repair workflow or manually disconnect all matching mounts and reconnect only once.

The Share Mounted On The Wrong Network

If the app says the share is on a fallback or slower path, use the repair flow to disconnect and reconnect on the preferred network when available.

> **Fixed in v0.5.3.** Earlier builds (v0.5.1 and v0.5.2) could falsely report `Mounted Wrong` or a duplicate for a share whose name matched a macOS system/autofs volume — most commonly a share called `Home`, which collided with the built-in `auto_home` volume named `home` — even though there was no real mount and no `-1` volume in `/Volumes`. v0.5.3 restricts detection to genuine network shares under `/Volumes`. If you saw this, install v0.5.3 and press `Refresh`.

A Share Keeps Disconnecting And Reconnecting

If a share repeatedly drops and auto-reconnects, the underlying NAS or network path is unstable. SMB Connect enforces a 60-second cooldown between reconnect attempts for the same share to prevent thrashing. Check:

- the physical network connection to the NAS
- whether the NAS is under heavy load or restarting services
- whether a VPN or firewall is intermittently blocking SMB traffic on port 445

If the flapping continues, consider disabling `Auto-reconnect dropped shares` in Settings → General until the network issue is resolved.

Auto-Reconnect Is Not Triggering

Auto-reconnect only fires when the share transitions from mounted to unmounted while the server is still reachable. It will not trigger if:

- the server itself is down or unreachable (the share shows `Unavailable`, not `Ready`)
- the share was never mounted in the current session (the app must have seen it mounted at least once)
- the 60-second cooldown from a previous reconnect attempt has not elapsed
- `Auto-reconnect dropped shares` is turned off in Settings → General

Appendix: SMB Connect Desktop Compatibility App

The separate **SMB Connect Desktop** app is retained for compatibility with older deployments. It is no longer needed for a full-size interface: the original SMB Connect app now provides its own optional Dock icon, application menus, toolbar, and resizable window through **Settings → General → Show Dock icon and desktop window**.

If SMB Connect Desktop is already installed, it can continue to show the shared share configuration and current mount state. Its role is a client of the original SMB Connect app. CopyTrust can use the same request path when it needs an approved volume before starting an ingest:

1. A Connect action checks that the share allows external mount requests.
2. Desktop sends a versioned request using the share's configured Mount Name, for example:

   ```
   smbconnect://v1/mount?volume=Example_Archive&request=
   <uuid>
   ```

3. macOS opens or activates the original SMB Connect app.
4. SMB Connect resolves the unique Mount Name, chooses the best reachable preferred or fallback endpoint, reads its own Keychain entry, performs the mount, and updates the shared status.

SMB Connect Desktop does not read, copy, or resave the SMB password. It cannot repair a conflicted mount or complete missing credentials itself; those actions open the original SMB Connect app. It can still display status, request connections for explicitly approved volumes, disconnect a mounted share, and reveal it in Finder.

For a new installation, install and use **SMB Connect** alone. Enable its Dock icon and full window if the menu-bar presentation is too compact. This keeps one credential authority and one mount authority while providing both interface styles.